

Stop scrolling. Start watching.

A project that recommends movies and shows based on how the user wants to feel.

7,848 titles

Mood-based

Easy shortlist

Izzatkhanim Mirzakhanova



Who I am



Izzatkhanim
Mirzakhanova

BACKGROUND

Student learning Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics

INTEREST

How data can be used to solve familiar, everyday problems

THIS PROJECT

A practical way to explore data cleaning, text analysis, and recommendations

Why I chose this project

“

I want to watch something,
but I do not know what.

A familiar problem

Streaming platforms offer a lot of choice, but choosing can take longer than expected.

I wanted to build something practical that I would actually use myself.

My goal: help the user choose faster by starting with their mood, not only a genre.

The value of the idea

THE PROBLEM

Too many choices

The user keeps scrolling and cannot decide.



MY SOLUTION

Ask about mood

The user describes the experience they want.



THE VALUE

A shorter list

Recommendations feel more personal and easier to choose from.

EXAMPLE "I want something comforting, funny, and not too intense."

The original dataset

SOURCE

Kaggle IMDb movies and shows dataset

The original CSV contained **7,850 rows**.

It included titles, years, content types, genres, ratings, votes, and descriptions.

1 Missing descriptions
Some titles had no useful story text.

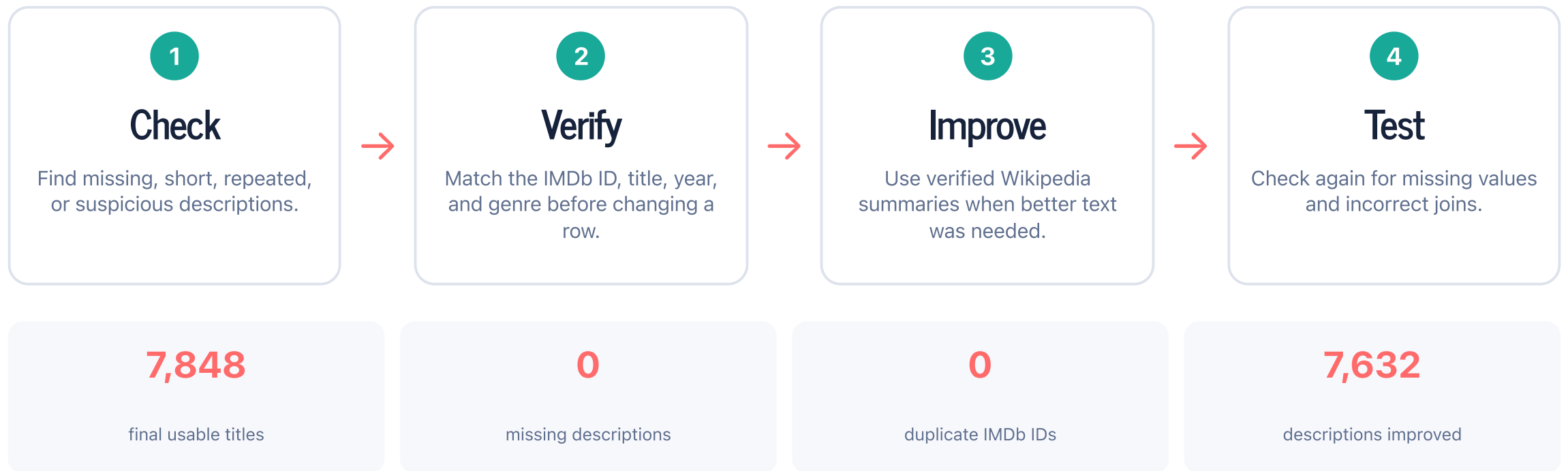
2 Wrong descriptions
Some descriptions belonged to another title.

3 Uneven quality
Some descriptions were too short, vague, or cut off.

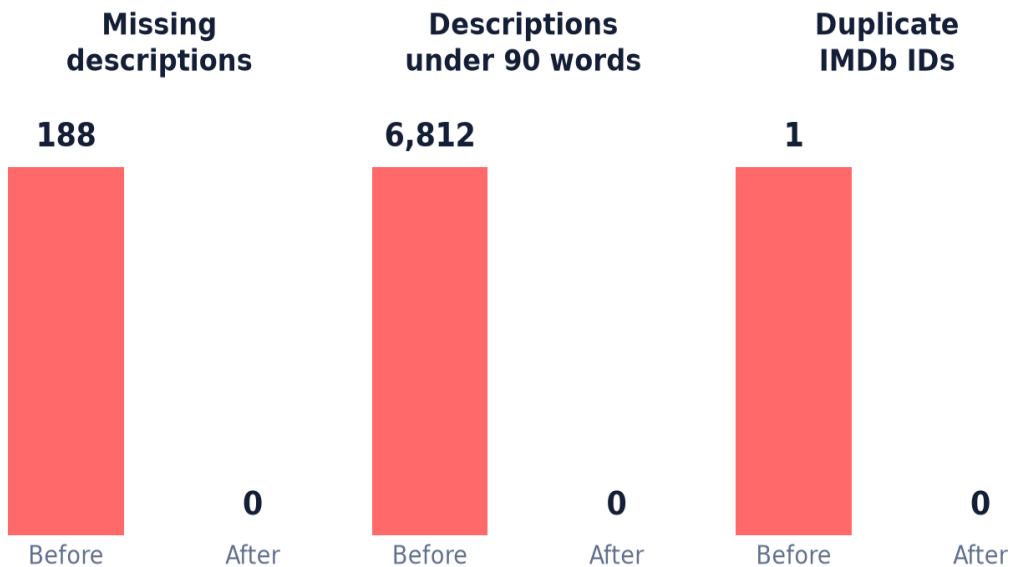
4 Missing genres
A small number of genre values were missing.

This mattered because the recommender depends heavily on the description of each story.

How I cleaned the data



Cleaning results: before and after



7,850

original rows

7,848

final rows

7,632

descriptions improved

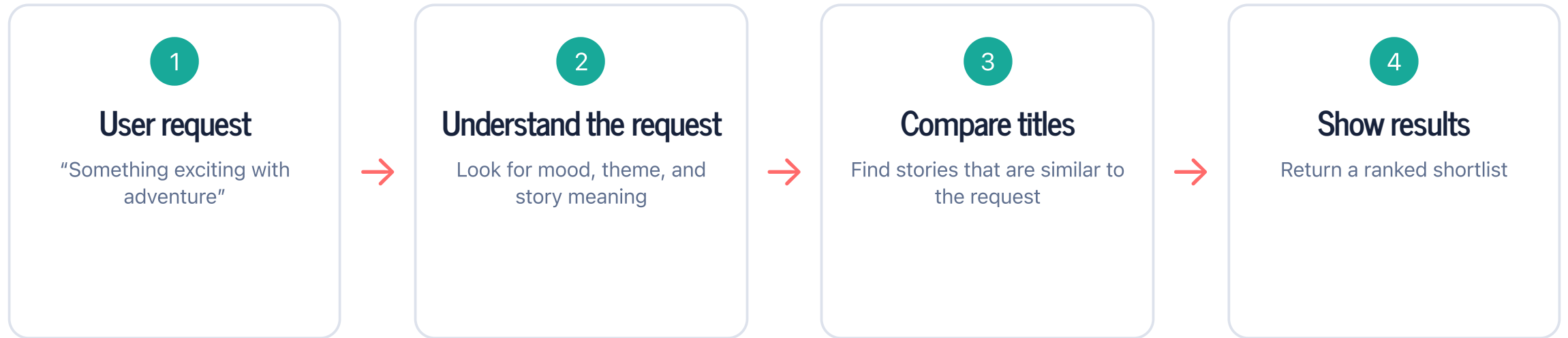
100%

meet the text target

The chart measures issues that can be counted automatically. Mismatched descriptions were also reviewed separately because they needed title-by-title checks.

Figure 1: Data-quality issues found before cleaning and remaining afterward

How the recommender works



In simple words: the computer turns text into numbers, compares those numbers, and finds descriptions with a similar meaning.

Project flowchart and architecture



Current stage: the model and recommendation function run in notebooks. **Future stage:** connect them to an API and user interface.

How the project developed

VERSION 1

Simple rules

I connected moods to genres and keywords.

Easy to understand, but too strict.



VERSION 2

Word matching

I compared words in the request and descriptions.

Better, but similar meanings can use different words.



VERSION 3

Meaning-based matching

The current version compares the meaning of the text.

More flexible and closer to natural language.



What decides the final order?

Match score How suitable is this
title for the request?

Story meaning

Does the description match what the user asked for?

Mood and themes

Does the title have the right feeling and subject?

Genre and format

Is it the kind of content the user wants?

Rating and votes

Is there enough evidence that viewers rated it well?

The final score combines these signals instead of trusting only one of them.

Example result recommendation from a prompt

USER PROMPT

"I want a tense zombie survival horror movie."

Horror · Thriller · Survival

The system reads the request and ranks the best matches.



Figure 2: Top five results returned for the zombie survival prompt

What works, and what is still missing?

WORKING NOW

The prototype can...

- recommend from a mood or written request
- find titles similar to a chosen title
- rank all 7,848 titles
- show why different signals affected the order

STILL MISSING

I have not yet...

- tested it with a group of real users
- measured whether users are more satisfied
- added titles released after 2023
- finished reviewing every automatic topic label

Reflection



What felt easier

Building the first rule-based version
and calculating scores.



What was difficult

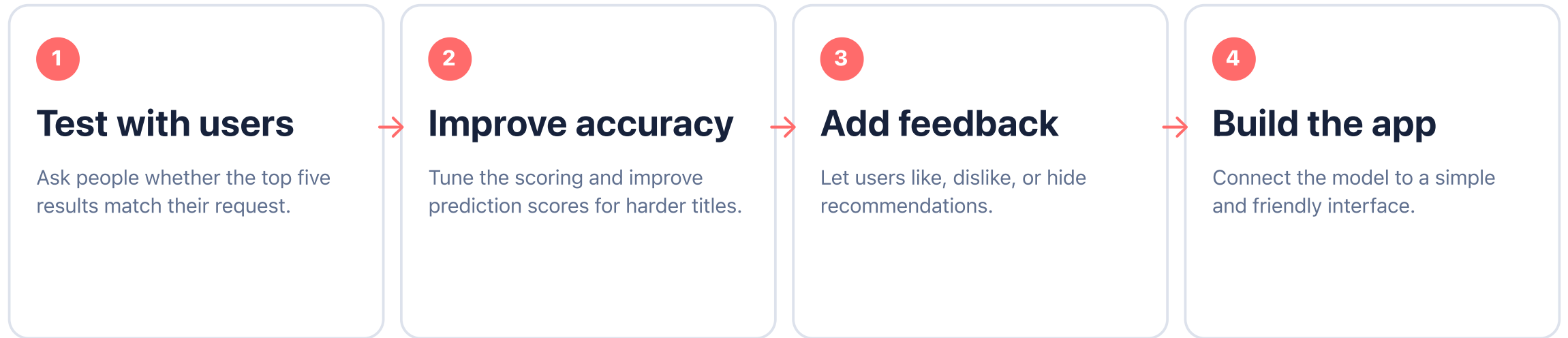
Finding wrong descriptions and
replacing them without mixing up
titles.



What I learned

Clean and trustworthy data can matter
more than using a complicated model.

What I would do next



MY FIRST PRIORITY

Test the recommendations with real people before making the model more complicated.

| Thank you

THE MAIN IDEA

< Choose by how you want to feel,
not only by what genre you know.

A cleaner dataset · a more natural search · a shorter watchlist

Questions?